

FOSS Bytes

Symbian open sourced

On February 4, the Symbian Foundation completed the open source release of the source code for the most widely-used smartphone platform. The move has been completed four months ahead of schedule. Symbian has been developed for more than 10 years and has shipped in more than 330 million devices around the world, before being open sourced.

Any individual or organisation can now take, use and modify the code for any purpose, for a mobile device or for something else entirely. This strategic move provides the Symbian ecosystem with greater potential for innovation, faster time-to-market and the opportunity to develop on the platform for free. Symbian's commitment to openness also includes complete transparency in future plans, including the publication of the platform roadmap and planned features, up to and including 2011. Anyone can now influence the roadmap and contribute new features. Visit www.symbian.org for more details.

You can now download all 108 packages containing the source code from Symbian's developer website (tiny.symbian.org/open), under the terms of the Eclipse Public License and other open source licences. Also available for download are the development kits for creating applications (the Symbian Developer Kit) and mobile devices (the Product Development Kit). These kits are compatible with Symbian^3, the very latest version of the platform, which is now fully open sourced and will be 'feature complete' during Q1 of this year.

Now, run SUSE Studio in-house

Novell has announced the SUSE Appliance Toolkit for ISVs and enterprises.

The Toolkit is a collection of tools designed to make building, testing, updating and configuring appliances, fast and easy. Developers can choose to build their appliances on either SUSE Linux Enterprise or openSUSE.

It features an on-site version of Novell's appliance-building solution, SUSE Studio, and new management tools that enable ISVs and enterprises to reduce software development time, installation cycles and maintenance costs. The Toolkit includes SUSE

Studio Onsite (a local, behind-the-firewall version of the online appliance creation tool), SUSE Studio Online, WebYaST (a tool for enabling remote, Web-based configuration of the SUSE Linux Enterprise), SUSE Lifecycle Management Server (a tool for authentication, entitlement and access control that makes it easier to distribute software patches and updates), and support for KIWI (the image creation tool behind SUSE Studio).

For ISVs, the SUSE Appliance Toolkit is an essential part of the SUSE Appliance Program, which enables ISVs to build, update, configure and go-to-market with fully-supported software appliances. The SUSE Appliance Toolkit is available at www.novell.com/toolkit.



Novel, LPI partner on Linux training and certification

Novell and the Linux Professional Institute (LPI) have announced an international partnership to standardise their entry-level Linux certification programs on LPIC-1. Under this program, Linux professionals who have earned their LPIC-1 status will also satisfy the requirements for the Novell Certified Linux Administrator (CLA) certification. In addition, Novell Training Services has formally agreed to include the required LPIC-1 learning objectives in its CLA course training material.

Adoption of Linux is accelerating as the industry pursues cost-saving solutions that deliver maximum reliability and manageability. A 2009 global survey of IT executives revealed that 40 per cent of survey participants plan to deploy additional workloads on Linux over the next 12-24 months, and 49 per cent indicated Linux will be their primary server platform within five years.

"This partnership represents the strong support the LPI certification program has within the wider IT and Linux community. This historical support has included contributions from vendors such as Novell and has assisted LPI to become the most widely recognised and accepted Linux certification," said Jim Lacey, president and CEO of LPI. More information about acquiring dual certification status can be found at Novell: www.novell.com/training/certinfo/cla, and at the LPI: www.lpi.org/cla.

